First 120 Days

# First 120 Days User Guide

How to explore the competency-based sales onboarding and manager enablement demonstration

Quick Start · Behind the Design: Claude AI–Assisted Development · Pathways · Competency evidence · Negotiation practice · Performance support

**Demonstration prototype, release candidate 3.** All people, companies, customers, products and records in the prototype and in this guide are fictional. This is a portfolio demonstration, not a production system or the official learning program of any company.

Screenshots in this guide were taken from the release-candidate 3 prototype with its fictional sample data. Numbered orange markers are annotations added for this guide; they do not appear in the prototype.

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# 1. Introduction and purpose

First 120 Days is an interactive demonstration of competency-based onboarding for new sales employees and their managers. It follows a fictional new account executive, Jordan Ellis, and their manager, Priya Raman, through the first 120 days in the role.

The demonstration shows four ideas working together:

- **Role-based pathways.** The employee and the manager each have their own activities and deadlines.
- **Coordinated responsibilities.** Manager activities prepare for, support and coach the employee's activities, and the two are linked.
- **Evidence-based competency assessment.** Eight demonstration competencies describe good performance. The manager records developmental ratings from evidence; completing activities never changes a rating.
- **Practice with reflection.** A branching negotiation scenario gives practice, consequences and feedback, followed by reflection and a manager debrief.

## How the experience is organized

| Level | What it is |
|---|---|
| Learning Pathway | Everything for one role over 120 days: Sales Employee or Sales Manager. |
| Completion milestone | A cumulative deadline: Before Day 1 (managers only), By Day 7, By Day 30, By Day 60, By Day 90 and By Day 120. Everything in a milestone is due by that day. |
| Learning track | A group of related activities in a milestone: HR & Workplace; Sales Skills & Processes; Company & Solutions; Community & Mentoring. |
| Learning activity | A single task, meeting, course enrollment, resource, scenario or debrief, with its own status and deadline. |

> By Day 7 and By Day 60 (plus the manager's Before Day 1 preparation) are fully built. By Day 30, By Day 90 and By Day 120 are shown so you can see the whole structure, but they are marked **Planned** and contain no activities.

**Opening the prototype.** Open **index.html** in a current web browser, or visit the address where it is hosted. No account, login or installation is needed. The prototype opens on the Experience Guide.

## 2. Quick Start: a five-minute tour

If you have only a few minutes, this tour shows the most distinctive features. The same five steps appear on the Experience Guide.

1. **Open an employee activity.** Choose *Explore Employee Learning Pathway*, open **By Day 60**, then **Start client meetings yourself**. Note the status control, What Success Looks Like and the competency labels. — about 1 minute

2. **Cross to the manager's side.** Under *How your manager supports this*, select **Shadow client meetings the new hire initiates**. The view switches to the Sales Manager, with structured guidance and a **Record Observation** button. Use **Back to** to return. — about 30 seconds

3. **Try the negotiation practice.** Open **Negotiation Practice** and make four connected decisions in *A Renewal Under Pressure*. Notice how earlier choices change later customer reactions. Answer the three reflection prompts and share them. — about 2 minutes

4. **Debrief as the manager.** Switch to **Sales Manager** and open **Scenario Debrief** to review the path and reflection, then save coaching notes. — about 1 minute

5. **See how competence is judged.** Open **Competencies**, then **Negotiation & Agreement**. Evidence has accumulated, but the rating has not changed. Only the manager rates, from at least two kinds of evidence. — about 30 seconds

To start again from the sample data, use **Demonstration controls** in the page footer.

## 3. Behind the Design: Claude AI–Assisted Development and Iterative Refinement

I designed this experience and directed its development from start to finish. I used Claude AI as a development partner for implementation, analysis, documentation and automated testing. Every instructional decision, requirement and refinement was mine to make and approve.

1 Design · 2 Claude AI–assisted development · 3 My hands-on UX testing · 4 Findings · 5 Refinement · 6 Claude-assisted verification

## My instructional design leadership

The starting point was a sales onboarding and manager enablement framework I originally developed as a working document for an enterprise sales organization. I:

- directed a full analysis of the framework, recording each decision in a private decision log
- designed the four-level architecture, the two role-based pathways and their coordinated responsibilities
- defined eight new competencies, the developmental scale and the two-kinds-of-evidence rating rule
- designed the branching negotiation scenario for practice, reflection and coaching
- set the requirements and acceptance criteria for each phase, and approved each phase before it began

## Claude AI's development and analytical contributions

Working to my requirements, Claude AI:

- structured the source inventory and its reconciliation checks
- drafted the design brief and documentation, including this guide, from my decisions
- implemented the prototype in plain HTML, CSS and JavaScript
- proposed options and flagged ambiguities and conflicts with earlier decisions
- helped me analyze my testing findings

Claude AI did not set the learning strategy. I reviewed and corrected its work throughout.

## My hands-on UX testing

I tested each iteration hands-on in both roles and evaluated the findings. I covered navigation, coordination between the pathways, cross-role links, milestone behavior, the scenario, evidence and rating safeguards, performance support, and instructional clarity. In one round, I confirmed that a competency joined the manager's review queue once it had two kinds of evidence, and left it once a rating was recorded.

## Claude-assisted regression testing

Claude AI wrote and ran automated browser tests after each round: functional checks, every scenario path, keyboard-only use, layouts at four screen widths, and selected accessibility checks. It also scanned the public files for confidential content. These tests used a single browser engine. I reviewed the results before accepting each round of changes.

## How testing changed the design

| Finding from my testing | Refinement I approved |
|---|---|
| “Route” was an ambiguous navigation label. | Renamed Learning Pathway; added the Experience Guide as the starting point. |
| Cross-role links worked only from manager to employee. | Links in both directions, with a Back to link. |
| Manager guidance said what to do, but not how. | Purpose, actions, what to look for, evidence and completion criteria; Record Observation. |
| A tools activity was mapped to Strategic Account Planning. | Link removed; every competency link audited and labeled Introduces, Builds or Produces evidence. |
| A resource title could not be opened. | Every resource opens a printable page; three Word templates. |
| The Experience Guide was too text-heavy for a first visit. | A five-minute tour up front, with details on demand. |
| The scenario outcome did not name the scenario. | The outcome screen now shows “A Renewal Under Pressure”. |

**Not yet done:** testing with external participants, screen-reader testing, testing across other browsers and devices, and an independent accessibility audit. I make no claim of accessibility conformance, and the prototype is not deployed as a production system.

# 4. Getting started: the Experience Guide and roles

The **Experience Guide** is the landing page. It explains the demonstration, offers two entry points and the five-step tour, and links to this guide.

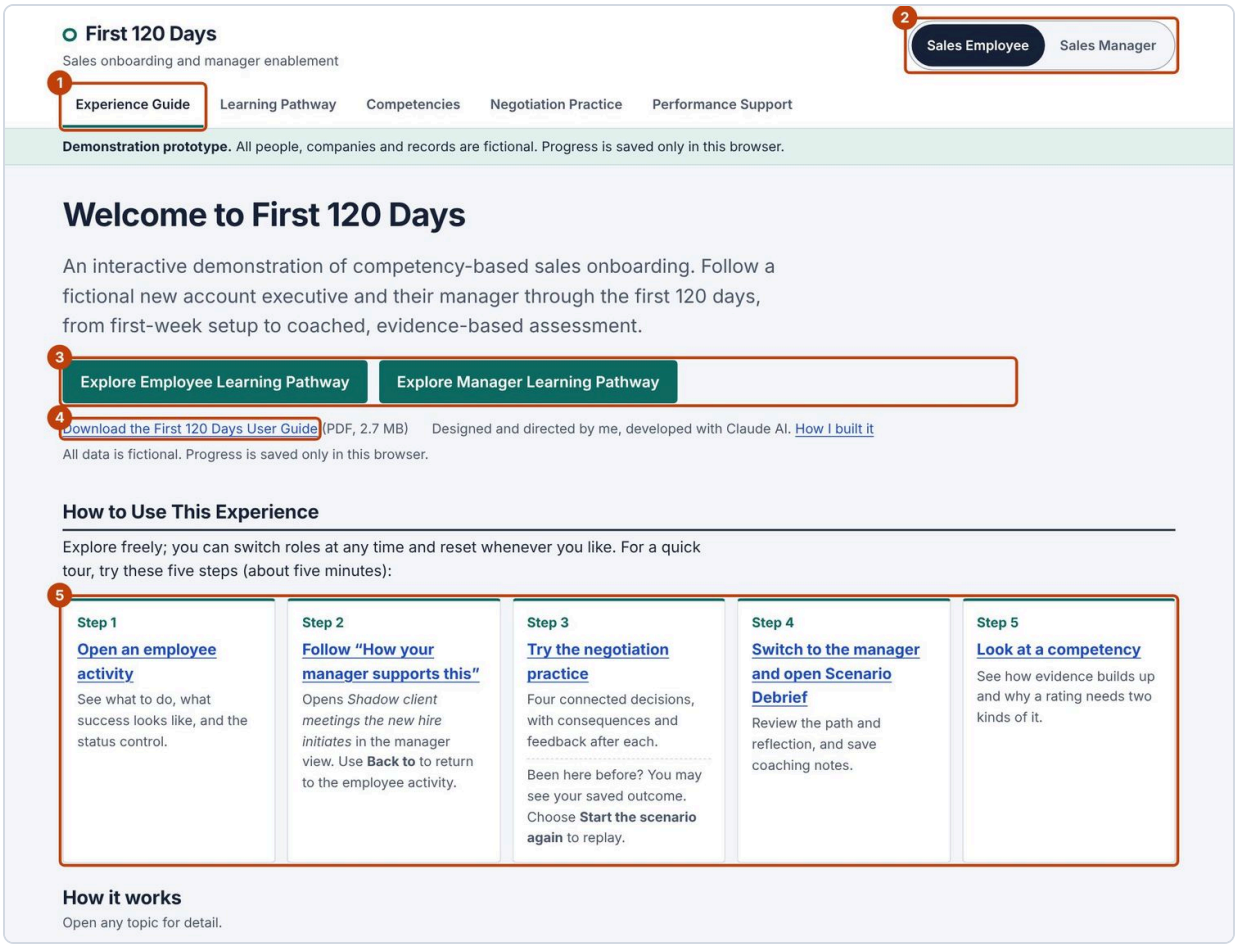



**Figure 1.** The top of the Experience Guide.

1. The main navigation: Experience Guide, Learning Pathway, Competencies, Negotiation Practice (Scenario Debrief for managers) and Performance Support.
2. The role switch. The pressed button shows the current view; switch at any time.
3. Entry actions that set the role and open that pathway.
4. The link that downloads this User Guide. Beside it, *How I built it* jumps to Behind the Design.
5. The five-step tour (section 2).

Below the tour, **How it works** groups detailed explanations into topics that open and close, so the page stays short. Further down are **Behind the Design**, disclosures and the **Demonstration Controls** used to reset progress.

**Links you can share.** Every milestone, activity, competency, resource and scenario page has its own address, which opens that page directly.

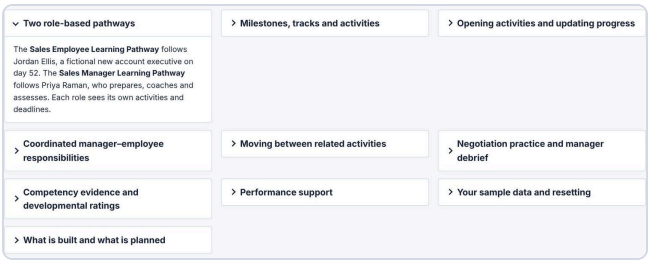



**Figure 2.** How it works: topics open for detail.

# 5. The Sales Employee Learning Pathway

Choose **Sales Employee**, then **Learning Pathway**, to see Jordan's view. The sample data places Jordan on day 52, with By Day 7 complete and By Day 60 under way.

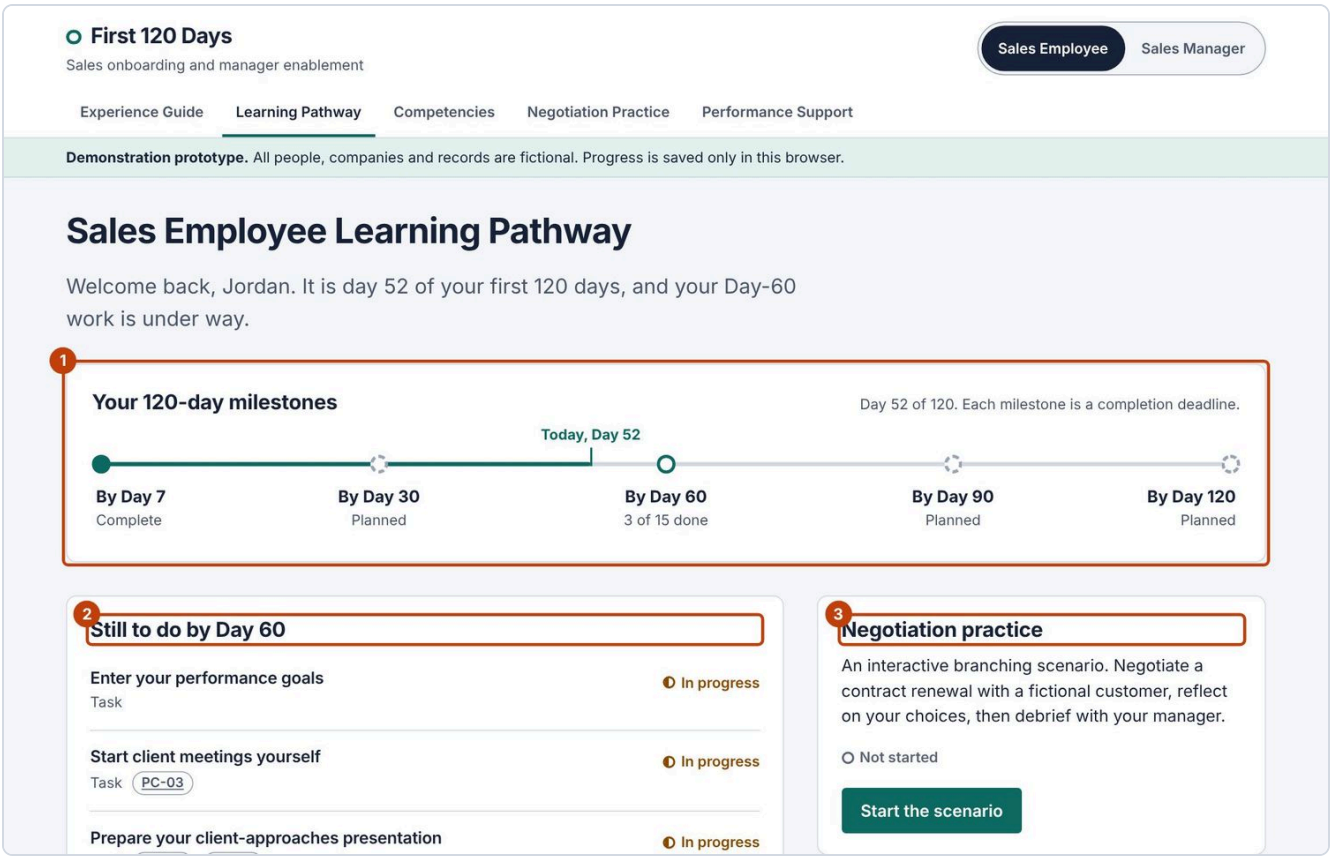



**Figure 3.** The Sales Employee Learning Pathway.

1. The 120-day milestone timeline; select a milestone to open it.
2. Activities still to do in the current milestone.
3. A shortcut to the negotiation practice.

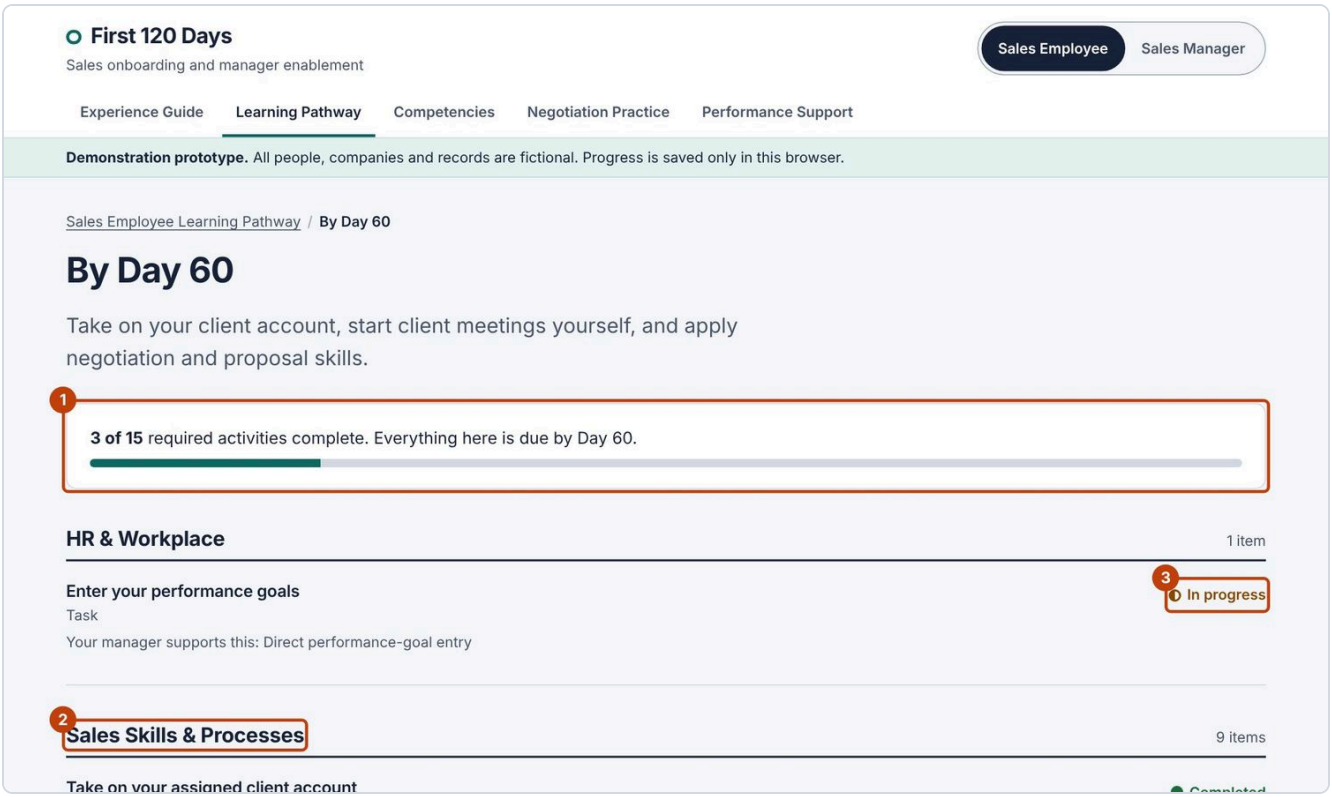



**Figure 4.** A milestone page.

1. Milestone progress: how many required activities are complete.
2. Activities grouped by learning track.
3. Each activity's status. A *Past due* tag appears when a required activity is incomplete after its milestone date.

## Activity pages and progress controls

Open any activity to see what to do, why it matters and when it is due. Substantive activities also describe **What Success Looks Like**.

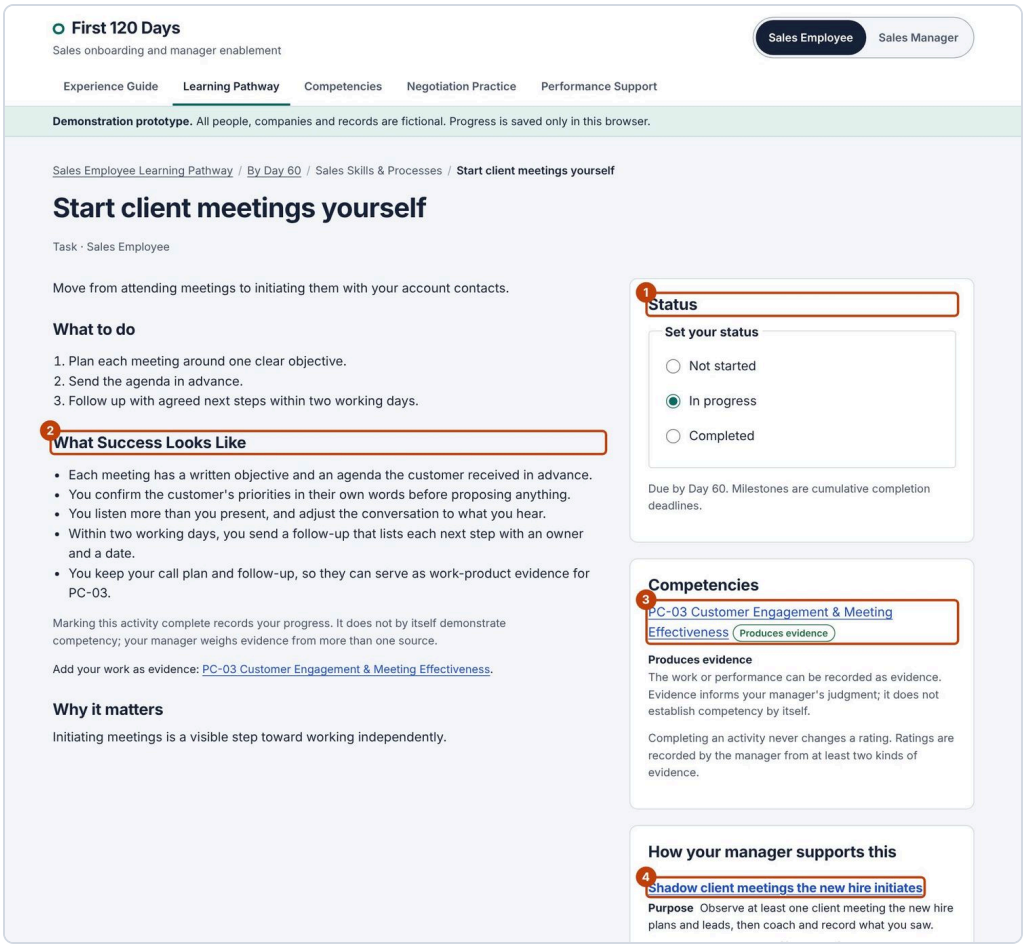



**Figure 5.** An employee activity: Start client meetings yourself.

1. Set your status: Not started, In progress or Completed. Changes save immediately and update milestone progress.
2. What Success Looks Like: observable behaviors that match the competency's indicators.
3. Linked competencies, each labeled Introduces, Builds or Produces evidence (section 10).
4. The related manager responsibility (section 7).

> Marking an activity complete records progress. It does not by itself demonstrate competency or change a rating.

**Course enrollment.** The core sales skills activity lists five courses, each with its own status: **Not enrolled**, **Enrolled**, **In progress** or **Completed**. The Day-7 requirement is met once all five are enrolled; course completion has no deadline in this demonstration. Enrollment alone is not evidence of competency.

# 6. The Sales Manager Learning Pathway

Choose **Sales Manager** to see Priya's view. The manager prepares and coordinates the onboarding, observes and coaches, and assesses each competency from evidence.

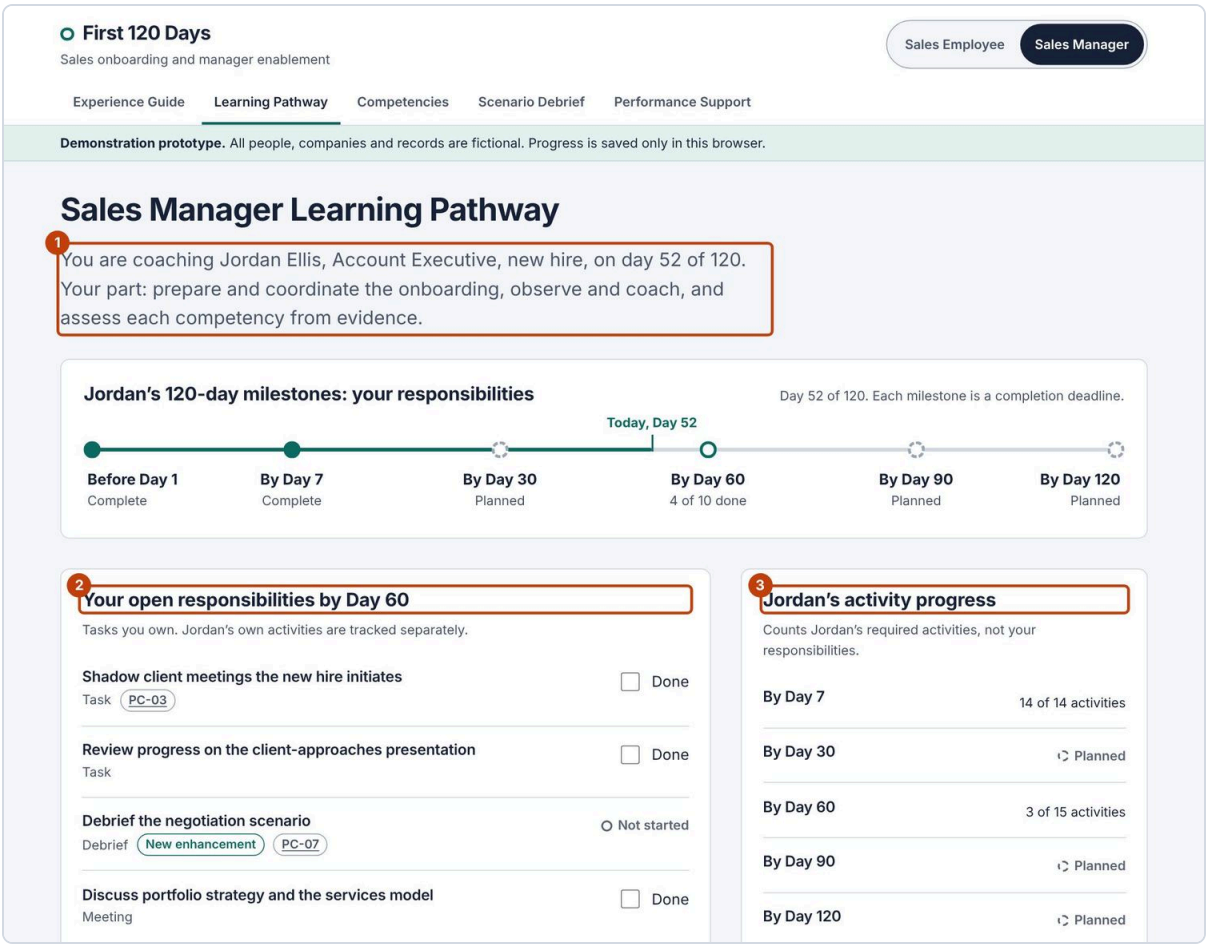



**Figure 6.** The Sales Manager Learning Pathway.

1. The introduction states the manager's coaching and assessment purpose.
2. Your open responsibilities: tasks the manager owns, each with a *Done* checkbox.
3. Jordan's activity progress: counts of Jordan's required activities, not the manager's.
4. Competency snapshot; each competency opens its evidence and rating page.

**Awaiting Your Review** lists work Jordan has shared, such as a scenario reflection, and competencies with enough evidence to assess. A competency appears there once it has evidence of two kinds and no rating, and leaves once the manager records one.

## Manager guidance

Performance-related manager activities set out purpose, what to do, what to look for, coaching considerations, evidence to record and completion criteria. Detail sections open and close; routine tasks stay brief. Recording evidence is recommended but is not required before the manager marks an activity done.

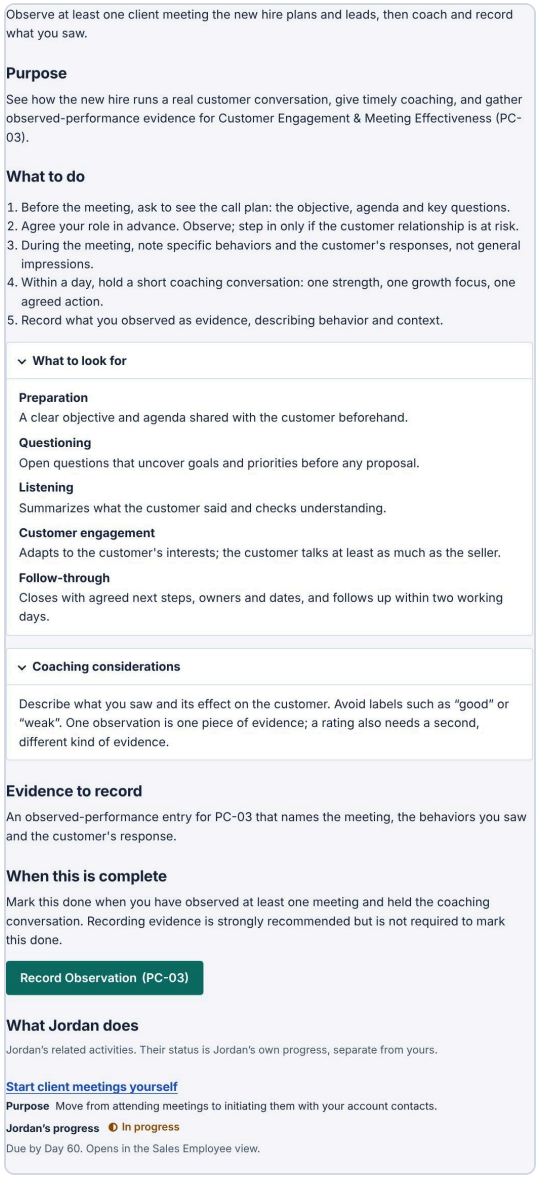



**Figure 7.** Guidance for *Shadow client meetings the new hire initiates*, with both detail sections opened. Record Observation opens the evidence form for PC-03.

# 7. Moving between related activities

An employee activity's **How your manager supports this** panel links to the related manager responsibilities; a manager activity's **What Jordan does** section links back. Each related item shows its **purpose** separately from its **progress** and says which view it opens in. Following a link switches the role automatically, and a banner offers a way back.

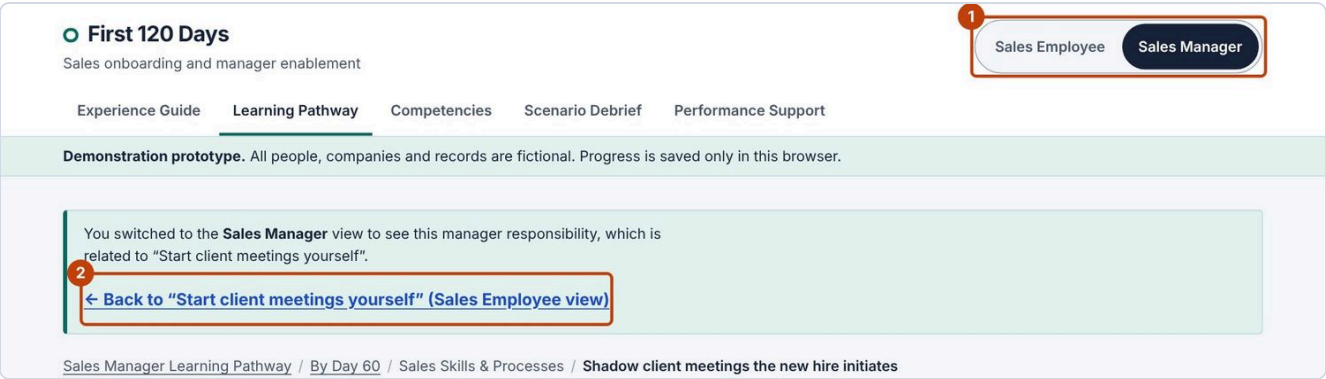



**Figure 8.** After following a link from an employee activity.

1. The view has switched to Sales Manager; navigation and breadcrumb follow.
2. **Back to** returns to the original activity in the Sales Employee view.

The role change is announced through a live region for screen reader users. Employee views show only a manager activity's purpose and progress, never private notes or assessment content.

# 8. Coordinated responsibilities

Some manager responsibilities have two steps with separate deadlines. *Sales tools and core course enrollment* has **step 1, before Day 1:** arrange tool access and course seats, and **step 2, by Day 7:** assign the tools orientation and the five course enrollments.

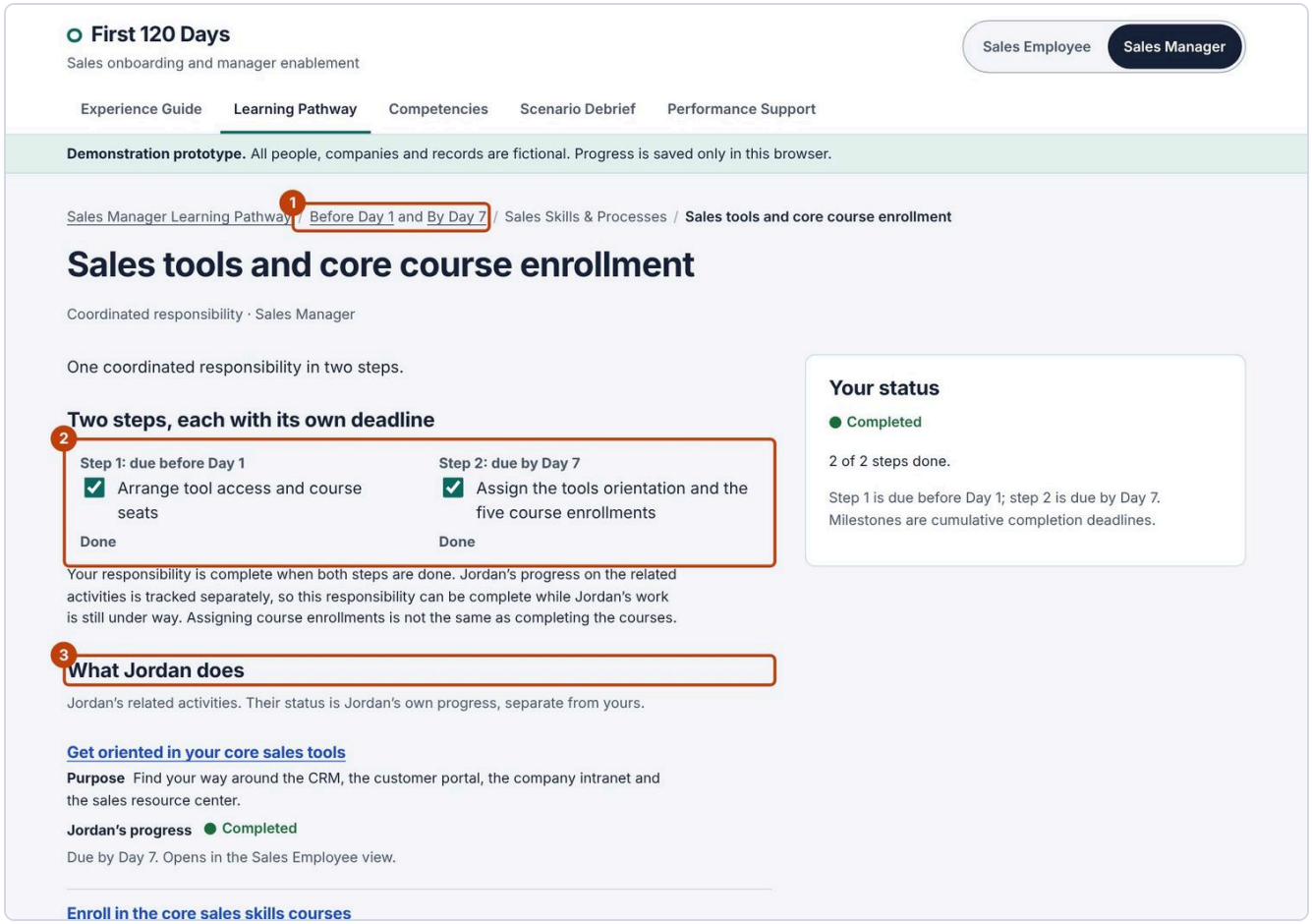



**Figure 9.** A coordinated responsibility.

1. The breadcrumb names both milestones.
2. Two steps, each with its own deadline, checkbox and Done or Not yet done state.
3. Jordan's related activities, with their own progress.

The responsibility is complete when both steps are done. Jordan's progress is tracked separately, so the manager's part can be complete while Jordan's courses are still in progress. Assigning enrollments is not completing courses. Each step also appears in its own milestone list and counts toward that milestone.

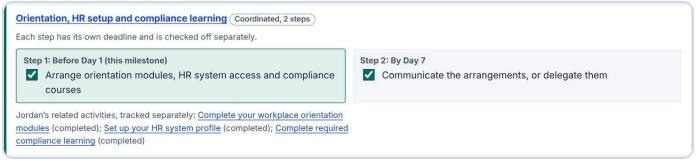



**Figure 10.** The same responsibility in the Before Day 1 list; the current milestone's step is highlighted.

# 9. Negotiation practice and manager debrief

As the Sales Employee, open **Negotiation Practice** to negotiate a contract renewal with a fictional customer in *A Renewal Under Pressure*, across four connected decisions:

1. Read the situation and choose **Start the scenario**.
2. For each decision, choose an option, optionally record your reasoning, and choose **Confirm choice**.
3. Read what happens, the feedback and the principle, and the effect on the relationship and the contract value retained.
4. Choose **Continue**, or **Try a different choice** to undo the decision.

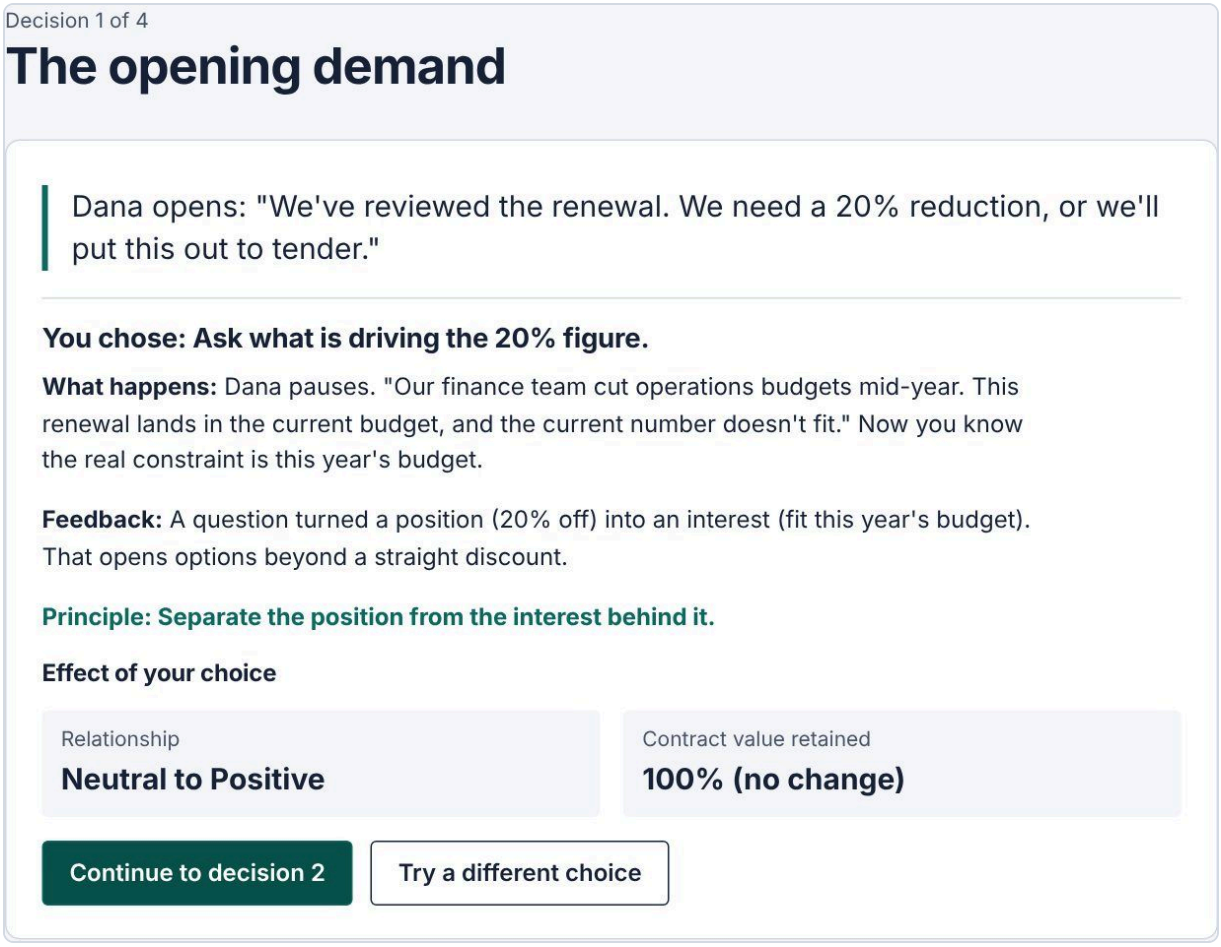



**Figure 11.** Feedback after a decision. Later customer reactions depend on earlier choices.

## Outcome and reflection

After four decisions you see one of four outcomes, a recap of your path and reasoning, and buttons to revisit any decision. The outcome screen names the scenario. Answer all three reflection prompts and choose **Save and share with my manager**. This records two pieces of evidence for Negotiation & Agreement (PC-07): your path and reasoning, and your reflection. Your rating does not change.

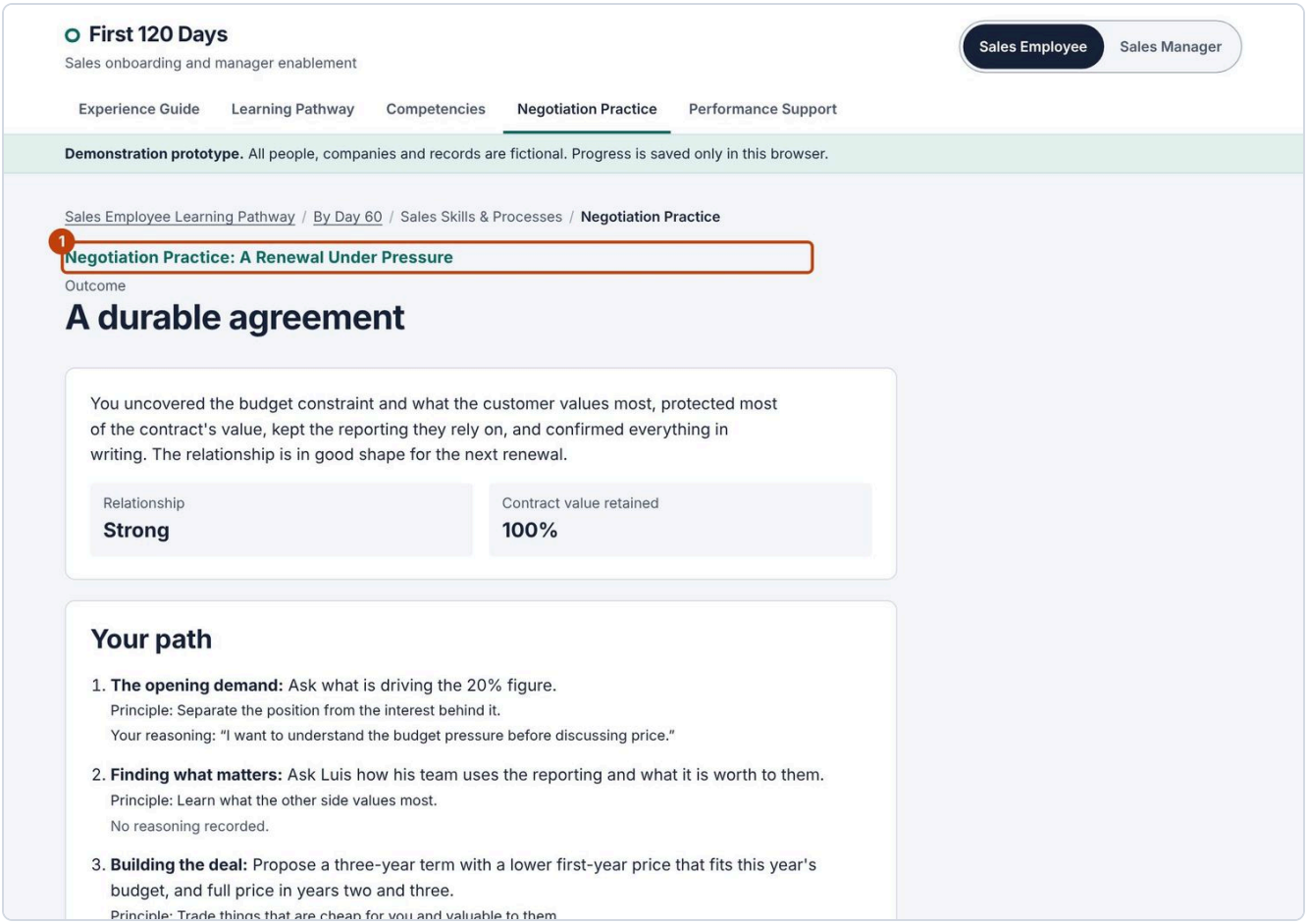



**Figure 12.** The scenario outcome. **1** The scenario name.

> The scenario is practice. Completing it, or reaching the best outcome, is not proof of negotiation proficiency.

### Manager debrief

As the Sales Manager, open **Scenario Debrief**. Once Jordan has shared a reflection, it shows the outcome, path, reasoning and reflection, with a four-question debrief guide. Saved coaching notes become developmental evidence for PC-07 and complete the manager's debrief activity.

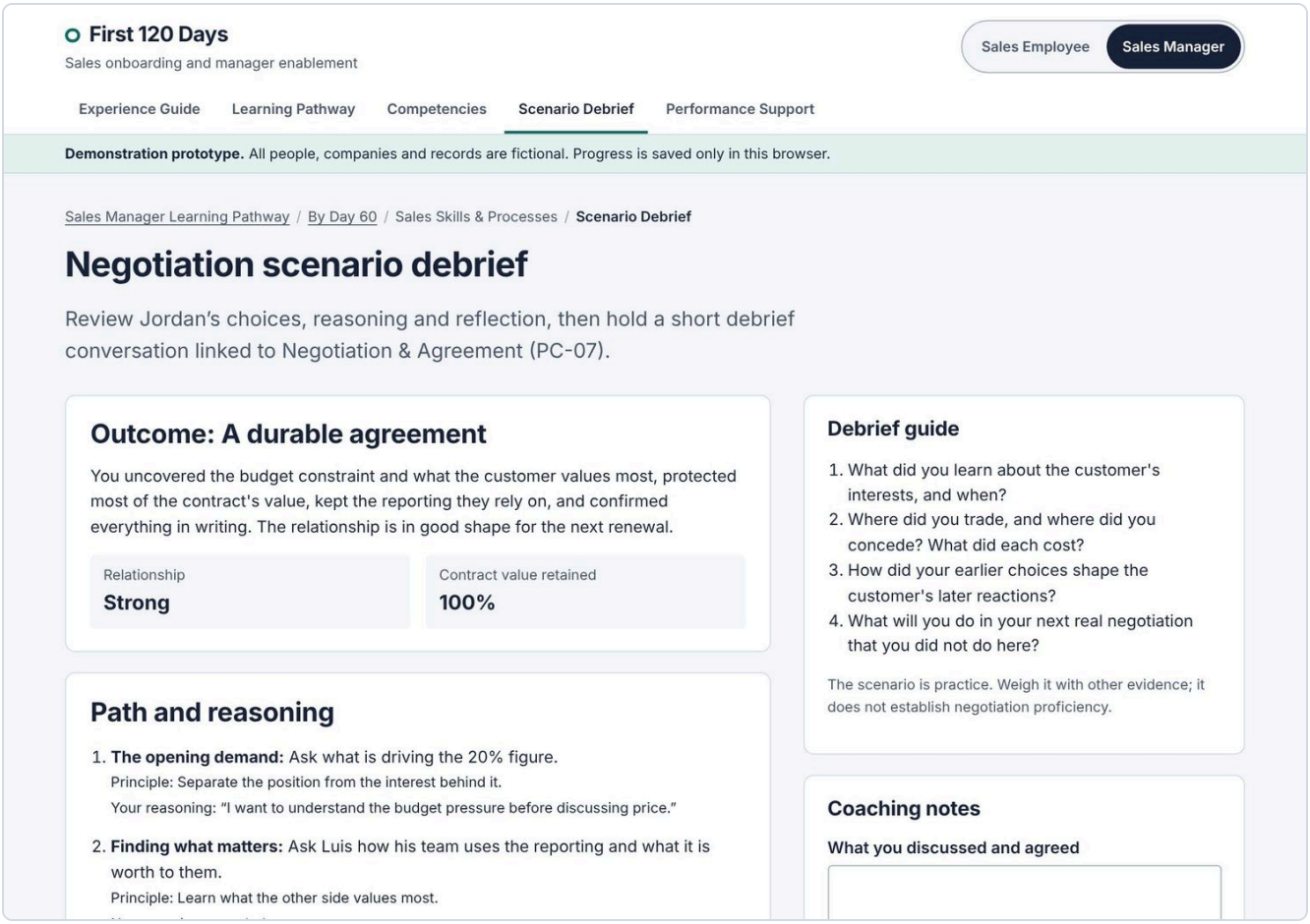



**Figure 13.** The manager's scenario debrief.

## 10. Competency evidence and developmental ratings

The **Competencies** page lists eight demonstration competencies, PC-01 to PC-08, with their current ratings, the developmental scale and how activities connect to competencies.

| Rating level | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Not yet observed | Insufficient evidence to evaluate the competency. This is not a judgment of performance. |
| Emerging | Demonstrates relevant behaviors with substantial guidance or inconsistent execution. |
| Developing | Demonstrates relevant behaviors in routine situations, with some coaching or refinement needed. |
| Demonstrating consistently | Independently demonstrates relevant behaviors across multiple situations, supported by documented evidence. |

| Link type | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Introduces | Orients you to the competency and what good looks like. It produces no evidence. |
| Builds | Learning or practice that develops the skills. Useful preparation, but not performance evidence on its own. |
| Produces evidence | The work or performance can be recorded as evidence. Evidence informs the manager's judgment; it does not establish competency by itself. |

## Adding evidence

Open a competency to see its indicators, typical evidence, related activities and evidence collected so far. Use **Add evidence** to record an item; the help text changes with the kind of evidence you choose.

| Kind of evidence | Who can add it | What to write |
|---|---|---|
| Work product | Employee | Name the artifact and explain what it shows against the competency's indicators. |
| Observed performance | Manager or mentor | Describe the situation, the specific behaviors and how the customer or colleague responded. |
| Developmental reflection | Employee, or manager as a coaching note | What was learned, what changed and what will be applied next time. Managers summarize the coaching conversation. |

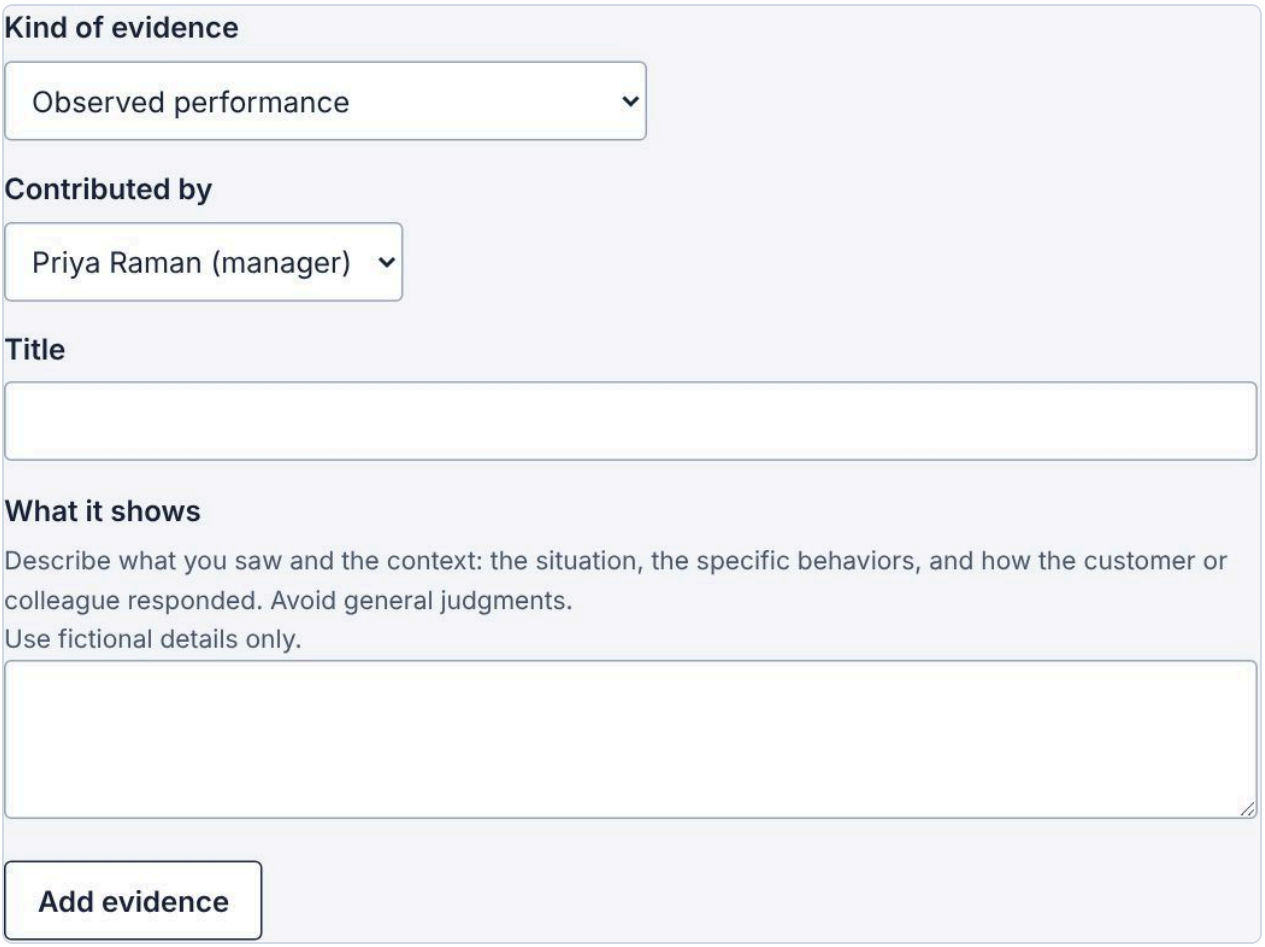



**Figure 14.** The evidence form opened from Record Observation, set to observed performance.

## Recording a rating (managers only)

The manager chooses a level, selects supporting evidence and adds a development note. Any level above **Not yet observed** needs at least two evidence items from two different kinds of evidence; otherwise the rating is not saved and an explanation appears. Every saved rating is added to the rating history.

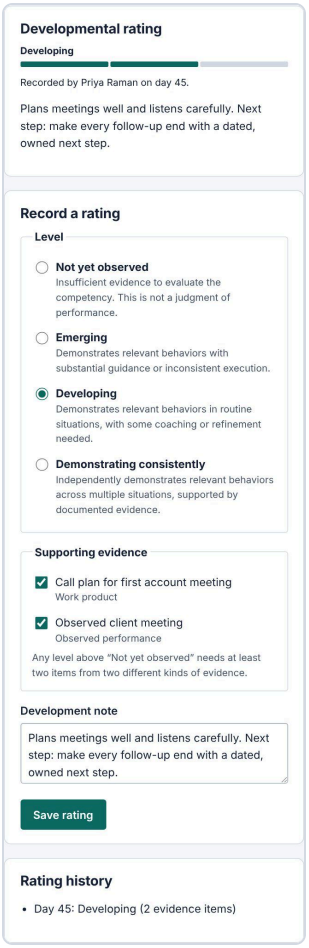



**Figure 15.** The manager's rating panel.

# 11. Performance support

**Performance Support** lists twelve fictional resources: job aids, templates, coaching guides and primers. Two coaching guides appear only in the Sales Manager view. Search by keyword or filter by topic and type; the number of results is announced to screen reader users.

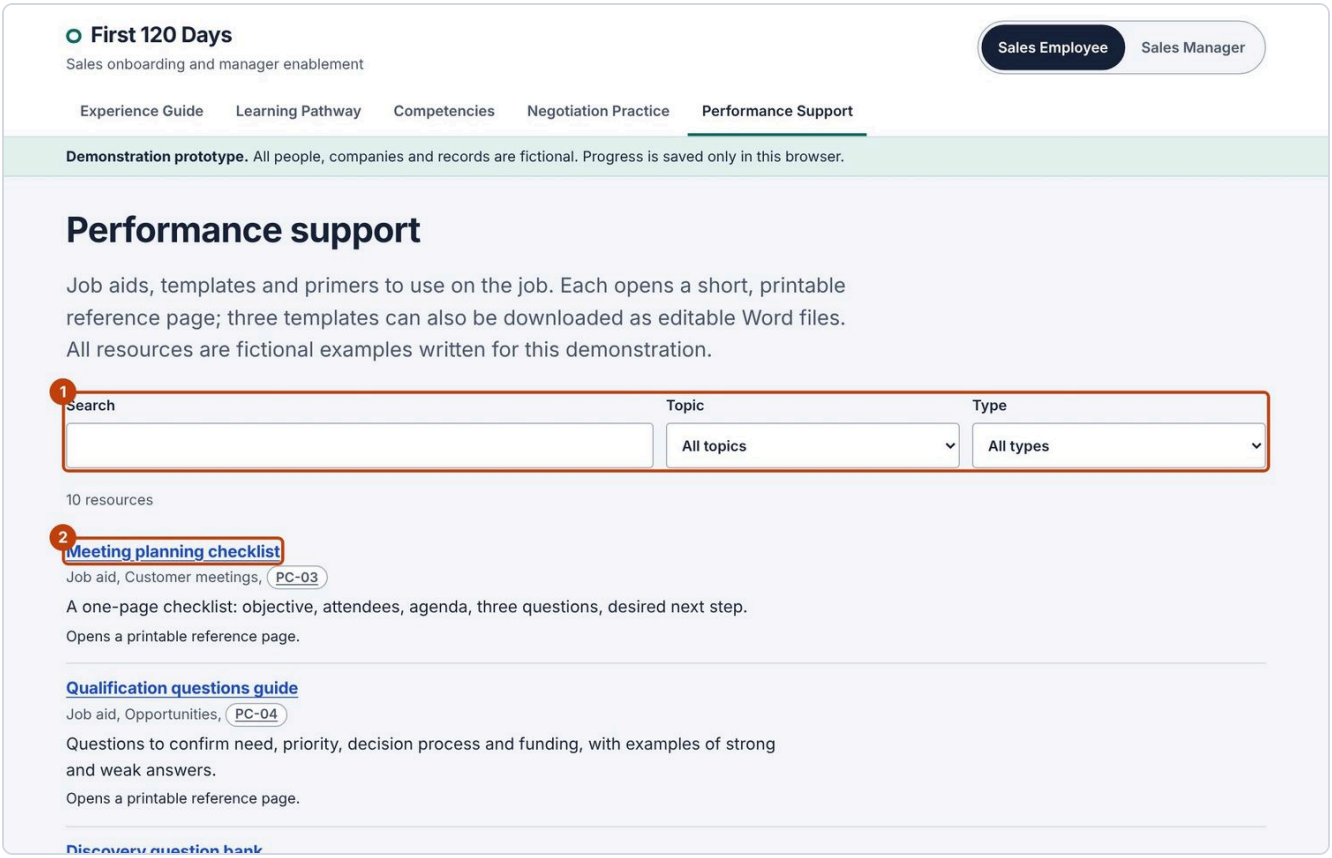



**Figure 16.** The performance support catalog.

1. Search and filters.
2. Each title opens a printable reference page.

Three templates also download as editable Word files: the **Account plan template**, the **Negotiation preparation worksheet** and the **Implementation handoff brief**. Activities link to the resources that help with them.

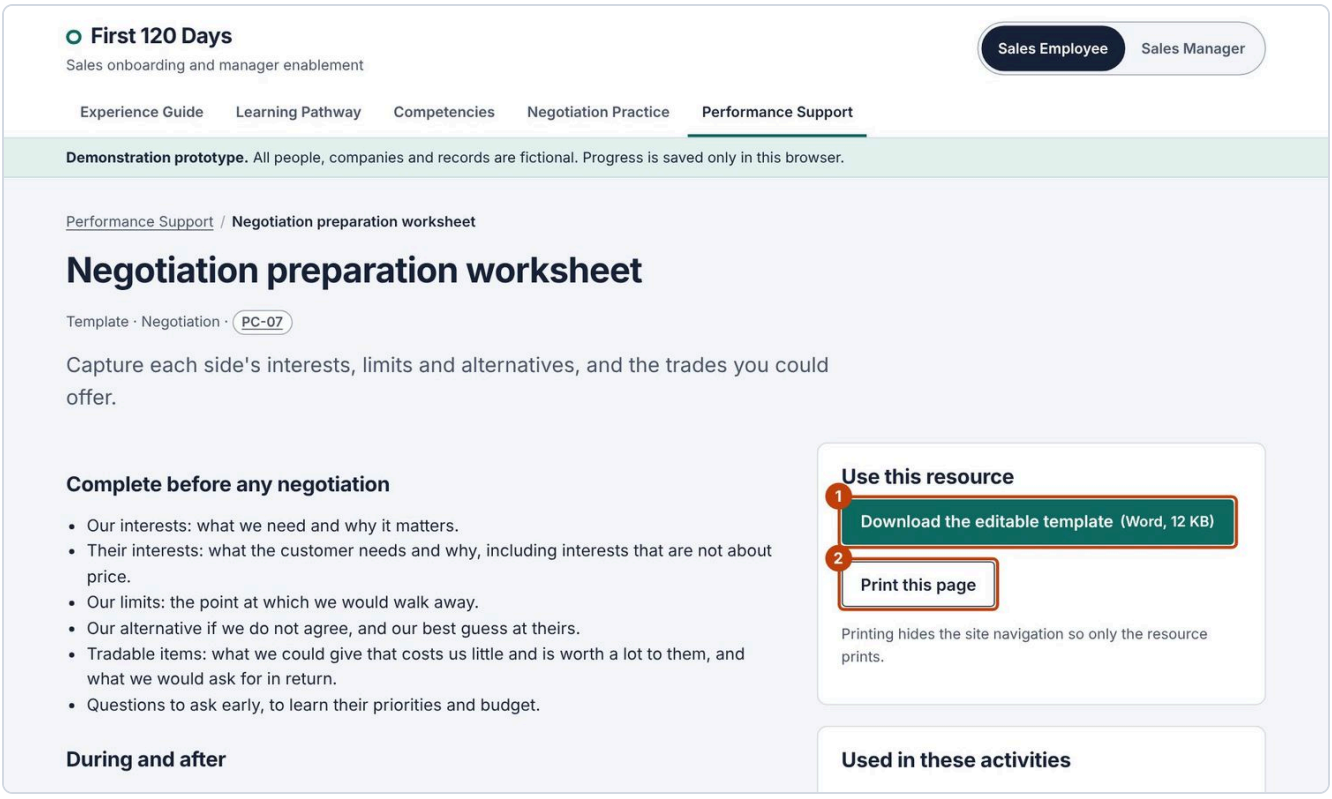



**Figure 17.** A resource page.

1. Download the editable Word template, where available.
2. Print the page; printing hides the site navigation.

## 12. Your data and resetting the demonstration

The prototype starts with fictional sample progress. Everything you change, such as statuses, evidence, ratings and scenario choices, is saved in your browser's local storage on this device. Nothing is sent to a server, and there is no login, tracking or analytics.

- Progress stays when you reload or return later in the same browser on the same device.
- It does not move to another browser or device and is not shared with anyone.
- If your browser blocks storage, as some private windows do, the prototype still works, but progress lasts only until you close or reload the page.

### To reset

1. Open the **Experience Guide** and scroll to **Demonstration Controls**, or select **Demonstration controls** in the footer.
2. Choose **Reset demo data…**.
3. Choose **Restore sample progress**, **Clear all progress** or **Cancel**.

You can also clear the prototype's data in your browser's site settings.

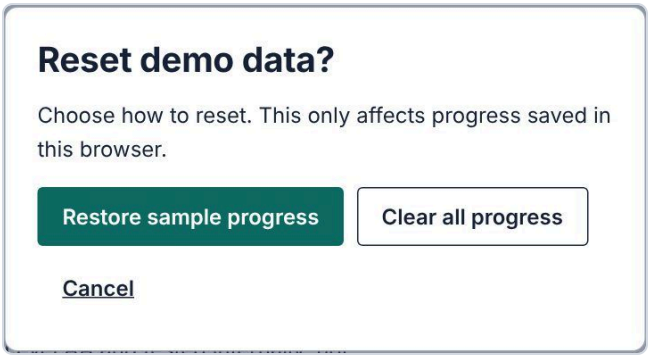



**Figure 18.** The reset dialog.

## 13. Fictional data and confidentiality

- **Fictional content.** All people, companies, customers, products, solution areas, resources and records are fictional and were written for this demonstration.
- **Adapted, not copied.** The design was informed by a historical professional onboarding working document. That material was adapted and sanitized: public content was newly written, generalized or fictionalized, and no confidential material appears in the prototype or this guide.
- **Not an official or production system.** The prototype is not a production system or the official learning program of any company.
- **Demonstration competencies.** The eight competencies and the rating scale were written for this demonstration. They are not an employer's official standard or a certification.
- **Do not enter real information.** Use fictional details only when you add evidence, notes or reflections.

## 14. Planned features and known limitations

| Status | Feature |
|---|---|
| Built | Both pathways with role switching; Before Day 1, By Day 7 and By Day 60; coordinated responsibilities; activity, step and enrollment progress; cross-role links with return; manager guidance and employee success criteria for key activities; competency evidence and ratings with safeguards; the negotiation scenario, reflection and debrief; twelve printable resources and three Word templates; Experience Guide and this guide. |
| Partly built | Manager guidance and What Success Looks Like cover selected performance-related activities, not every activity. Resource pages are concise illustrative job aids rather than complete working documents. |
| Planned | Activities for By Day 30, By Day 90 and By Day 120; role-specific learning for assigned solution areas; further templates. |

- **Single-device data.** Progress is stored in one browser on one device; both roles are simulated in the same browser.

- **Fixed sample day.** The employee is on day 52; dates do not advance.
- **Accessibility.** The design target is WCAG 2.1 Level AA. Automated checks and keyboard tests have run in one browser engine. Screen-reader testing, other browsers and devices, and an independent audit have not been done, and no conformance claim is made.
- **No formal usability study.** Testing so far is my own hands-on testing, supported by Claude-assisted automated tests. No external participants have taken part.

USER GUIDE UPDATE | NOVEMBER 2026

# Guided Navigation: Next Step Panels

This update supplements the existing First 120 Days User Guide (release candidate 3). The learning pathways, competency rules, negotiation practice, and manager debrief instructions remain unchanged.

## What is a Next Step panel?

A **Next Step** panel appears near the bottom of supported screens. It recommends a relevant action based on the page you are viewing, such as continuing to a related activity, returning to a milestone, or moving to another part of the demonstration.

## How to use it

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. Find the panel | Scroll toward the bottom of the current page and look for the section labeled “Next Step.” |
| 2. Review the suggestion | Read the contextual guidance. The recommendation may differ depending on the screen or role. |
| 3. Choose whether to follow it | Select the offered link or button to continue, or use the main navigation to go elsewhere. |

## Important: suggested, not required

Next Step panels are optional navigation aids, not additional assignments or completion requirements. They do not change activity status, competency evidence, developmental ratings, or saved progress merely by being displayed.

The main navigation and role switch remain available. You can move freely between the Sales Employee and Sales Manager experiences as described in the guide.

Visual note: the interface now uses stronger navy-to-teal headers, updated five-step tour cards, and improved text contrast. These presentation changes do not alter the five-minute tour instructions.